

X.Org Foundation. The Open Group gave the foundation the right to use the X.Org domain name, in effect becoming the front for X and being recognised for all the development that it did. This also brought many developers to the X.Org Foundation, which till then mostly consisted of vendors. X.Org Foundation membership was free for individuals, and corporate membership came for a sponsorship, which was necessary for X.Org to sustain itself. Several corporates such as HP, Sun Microsystems and IBM are now members of the X.Org Foundation.

4.1.2 Window managers

A window manager is an X client responsible for positioning windows on the screen, title bars, displaying messages to the user, focusing windows, and reading customised key strokes and mouse behaviour.

Some of the commonly-used Window Managers are KWin, Metacity, MWM, TWM, Sawfish, Enlightenment and BlackBox. KWin is the default window manager for the K Desktop Environment (more on desktop environments in a while), and Metacity is the window manager for the Gnome desktop environment. There are plenty of window managers you can download and install to change the look and feel of Linux. It is possible to give a whole new avatar to your computer with the different Window Managers and Desktop Environments.

Each window manager is created with a different focus. One can be fast and slick, another navigable, another customisable and another simply minimalist... And for the “I want Windows” people, there are also window managers that ape anything from Windows 3.11 to XP.

Window managers do a lot more than simply resizing and moving windows. They provide what has come to be a cool feature in Linux—multiple desktops. You can have four or more desktops and store files, shortcuts on them just like a normal desktop. You can switch from one desktop to another with a simple mouse